

Ink Morrow

WHERE STORIES GROW CLAWS

5.0 EDITION

Security, Privacy & AI Boundary

What crosses the threshold, what stays local, and who remains in control

For operators, players, and security reviewers / November 2026

Security, Privacy & AI Boundary

InkMorrow is private-by-default self-hosted software for one owner. This book distinguishes browser access, filesystem access, provider exposure, generated prose and portable files.

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01 Narrative memory and provider exposure

The narrative compiler reads only the selected ancestry and applicable character/ editorial revisions. A bounded fact-source projection can include exact original narration, submitted input or owner assertions, with source kind, field and hash; initial facts and missing exact evidence do not acquire fabricated precision. These private context records go only through the explicitly reviewed existing narration/quality roles. Consent fingerprints and conservative input bounds include the new exposure. They are never added to public recall, reader APIs, books or reading-copy documents. Complete cast/private motives remain narrator input, not character knowledge or permission to reveal secrets.

Physical presence, ownership/possession, significance, knowledge, claims and performed events remain separately qualified. A chapter handoff cannot promote a proposal or intention into a completed event, grant a challenge, move a character or take over an inhabited player's speech/choices/feelings. New guidance is not a semantic proof; existing validation/review and immutable evidence still apply.

No extra planner/critic endpoint, background inference, credential export or new share authority is introduced. An optional future literary evaluation requires its own explicit scope and paid ceiling. Deterministic fixtures use synthetic stores/transports, preserve failures and make no paid provider call.

02 B7 readable books, Bookshelf and reading copies

Gate separates **Make a readable book** from **Keep playing elsewhere**. A book uses the viewed path and inspection moment without activating it. Set title, author credit, language and optional front/back matter. Details are private server drafts and recover after reload; edits invalidate the current preview. Preview shows contents, included cover/placed art, sample prose and exclusions. Empty planned groups, Ask, directions, private references, other paths and audio do not enter the frozen PublicationDocument. Prose itself may contain fictional secrets.

Build frozen edition renders selected formats or all nine locally: DOCX, ODT, RTF, EPUB, PDF, HTML, Markdown, plain text and JSON. Every adapter uses the same immutable source. EPUB places art on a separate page immediately before its prose. A build is a durable job, independent of later story changes. Reopen a retained edition to inspect/cancel a running job. Restart marks abandoned jobs interrupted; navigation/restart never silently rebuilds. A partial failure retains successful formats. Missing/damaged files remain unavailable until an explicit local build; verified identical files can be reused for free. Earlier editions stay frozen.

Bookshelf loads bounded pages of retained books, audio and owner-only story art. Filter the collection, download available formats, play prepared MP3, or return to the source story. Older source, interrupted jobs and unavailable bytes are labelled. Loading the collection starts no renderer, model request or full-story download. Removing a book edition revokes its links and releases only files with no other edition pins. Source fiction remains intact. Private `.inkmorrow5` saves preserve all paths and source images, but exclude prepared books/audio, jobs and reading-link authority. Download prepared editions separately.

Reading links appear only when an administrator configures `PUBLIC_SHARE_BASE_URL` as an HTTP(S) origin and separately provides reachable hosting/allowed-host/proxy configuration. Local export works with sharing unconfigured. Review the exact frozen contents, choose expiry and explicitly create a link. Anyone possessing it can read that copy until expiry/revocation; downloaded copies cannot be retracted. Copy the URL, or select it manually if clipboard access fails. Stored link listings show expiry/revocation, never recoverable bearer tokens. Create a new link if lost.

The new current-fiction adapter stores only a SHA-256 capability hash. Its token travels in a URL fragment and an Authorization header, not a query/path or request log. The unauthenticated adapter serves only the immutable reader-safe document; all owner edition/assets/job APIs remain behind owner/origin/CSRF guards. Reader responses and pages use no-store/noindex/no-referrer, render text safely and make no AI call. Retired authoring and legacy share APIs remain disabled in production. This feature supplies no automatic hosting/deployment or promise of public reachability.

Schema 29 is appended without altering earlier migration source checksums. Source snapshots embed bounded art bytes in one synchronous read cut, independent of later media removal. Initial limits: 96 MiB per source, 1,000 sources / 512 MiB aggregate, 20 queued/running jobs, 10,000 retained jobs, 256 MiB per output and 2 GiB available rendered files. GC marks unreferenced files unavailable before unlink; new pins require availability. No story prose, private state or provider spend is rewritten.

03 B6 listening to saved fiction

Desk and Gallery offer **Listen to saved text**. Choose the configured MP3-capable Narrator voice, Read aloud, Auto-read or an audiobook edition, and a saved passage, path, chapter or volume. **Preview listening plan (free)** freezes that selection and shows segment counts, cached reuse, maximum synthesis calls and exposure. Only selected narrative prose goes to the Narrator: no Ask, private references, owner directions, correction records or sibling paths. Generated prose itself may contain fictional secrets; this is not semantic spoiler filtering.

A new purchase needs consent scoped to that immutable plan. Synthesis is sequential, with no transport retry, recursive splitting or purchased PCM fallback. Read aloud caps at 16 segments; Auto-read/audiobooks at 512. A unit caps at 16 MiB and an edition at 512 MiB. Choose a smaller passage/chapter/volume if preflight rejects the range. There is a 20-job installation queue and a conservative 4 GiB retained-audio quota.

The shared player keeps a labelled source, preparation progress, cancellation and Return action across rooms. Pause/Stop playback differs from **Cancel remaining synthesis**. Voice choice and playback speed are device preferences; changing speed and replaying a cached edition are free. A story/path change pauses Auto-read and requests cancellation of its remaining synthesis. A failed cancellation is reported rather than treated as confirmation. Tap to resume handles browser autoplay refusal without another purchase. Lock clears private playback UI.

Cancellation prevents undispatched units; dispatched work may still cost money and produce reusable cache bytes. Restart interrupts unfinished work without automatic resumption. Review a new plan to reuse completed units and purchase only permitted missing units. A disappeared or corrupt reviewed cache hit fails instead of silently buying a replacement. Retained job status shows known dollars and unknown-cost attempts separately. A late status reply cannot revive a cancelled player display.

Audio editions retain their source and are labelled older when the selected path has moved on. Download the MP3 separately. Private playable saves carry aggregate spend but exclude synthesized audio, listening plans/jobs, credentials and resumable purchase authority. Keep cold installation backups for configured database/media.

04 B5 retained visual collection

Gallery now lists the story-owned image collection in metadata pages of forty, including unplaced uploads and painting results. Thumbnails load lazily; Preview shows the full image, provenance and bounded retained-use metadata. Choose a cover, private reference or ancestral passage before placing an existing image. Placement and removal are local actions; earlier path snapshots and retained collection bytes remain available. New painting is one explicitly reviewed Illustrator purchase. A changed path, cancellation or restart cannot silently attach a late result: validated bytes remain ready and unplaced, and known/unknown spend remains visible. There is no automatic retry or reference-image conditioning.

The existing 400-image story ceiling remains. Every inventory member is an owned retained root; this batch exposes no permanent asset deletion or garbage collection. Playable save v2 carries all owned images and optional inventory descriptions and provenance, but no painting jobs, action keys, consent or provider credentials. Import creates new image identities and a fresh inventory concurrency value.

Visual Library offers selected-reference bundles (`.inkrefs`): worlds, characters and Scribes with normalized images and private lore/motives. Preview names matching existing entries; import always makes independent copies. A repeated identical import action returns the original copies, changed bytes conflict, and deleted results are reported rather than recreated. Bundles omit credentials, purchase journals and image-conditioning permission. They are unencrypted private files, not reader-safe books or full installation backups.

05 B4 editorial authority boundary

Chapter/volume organization is local, versioned presentation metadata. It performs no provider call, establishes no fictional event and grants no wording-editing permission. Ordinary outlines expose headings/ranges at a selected ancestry; drafts remain explicit authenticated owner work. New commands require the actual active path/head, current story revision and expected layout base. Historical browsing cannot silently become the mutation destination.

Stable anchors must already be narrative passages on the producing history. Strict save validation rejects sibling/future/local anchors, unknown fields, duplicate or shared producers, invalid parent chains, canonical effects on editorial records and snapshot heads changed without a producing revision. A temporary validation projection preserves original evidence and frozen-v1 contracts. Layout revisions travel in private saves; draft keys, receipts and paid authority do not.

The editor preserves private draft conflicts and uncertain local-action receipts. Close/Back/room changes/Lock fence abandoned callbacks; incomplete offline edits are not called server saved. Book formats consume the same effective grouping and original prose/placed images; empty plans add no synthetic paragraphs. D1 wording editing, D2 conversion and D3 image conditioning remain disabled pending separate decisions. Current manuals cover schema 29, B5–B7 and source-grounded narrative guidance.

06 B3 private creative data and bounded narration

World lore, character motives/background, Scribe craft, creative free text, scene proposals and campaign secrets belong to explicit authenticated owner tasks. Ordinary story projections expose a whitelisted creative summary; proposed scenes and revision baselines do not become public events. Reviewed narration still sends private branch truth/references/knowledge to the selected provider. A reference change cannot reveal a secret or establish a completed backstory event.

Free operation-plan preparation knows every possible draft/review/repair stage. Unknown capacity blocks that purchase; catalogue/owner-declared context and output limits bind consent. The byte-bound counter is conservative, not exact tokenization. Stages recheck before dispatch and transport cannot silently enlarge output for reasoning or retry. Known/unknown charges survive invalid, oversized and stale results. Narration Remember is optional and changes to relevant configuration or bounds require a new review. No paid permission, plan, credential or capacity is exported in a playable save.

Owner Say text is assembled once only after a performed occurrence, with source segments/ranges/hashes distinct from ordinary narration and asides. Editorial input cannot prove an external outcome; abandoned/failed goals cannot be sold as achievements. Saves validate exact source closure, producing revisions and selected ancestry before remapping. New local-command receipts/fences and scoped drafts prevent lost-response retries from becoming duplicate mutations. Lock clears private task controllers and DOM; offline unsaved memory is never represented as server acknowledgement. Current sources/PDFs cover the completed recovery capabilities.

07 Threat model and trust map

The owner controls the machine, network, provider profiles and downloaded files. The browser password protects the HTTP application; it does not encrypt all data at rest or protect against someone who controls the operating-system account.

Boundary	Trusted responsibility	Untrusted input
Browser to server	Auth, origin, CSRF, bounded parsing	URLs, bodies, filenames, stale revisions
Server to SQLite/media	Transactions, private paths, integrity	Old files, corrupt journals, imported graphs
Server to provider	Explicit exposure and bounded dispatch	Model prose, effects, reviews, errors, costs
Story to reader	Public current-path projection	Hidden state and other-path references
Story to book	Selected prose and current illustrations	Private metadata accidentally included
Story to save	Complete validated continuation graph	Imported fields, cycles and media bytes

A fictional character's refusal is not real authorisation. The owner can correct world facts through authenticated local controls; narration cannot use claimed royal authority to change application permissions.

No hosted multi-user account boundary, MFA or email recovery is claimed. Deploying the software for other people or adding remote access changes the threat model and needs a deliberate review.

B1 keeps all five rooms behind the existing authenticated bootstrap. Lock hides and clears current story content, contribution buffers and password fields before awaiting logout; stale result handlers remain fenced by the lifecycle epoch. Room changes within the same story retain pending-operation authority instead of creating a new purchase. The full-height contribution task and paid review share the modal stack; background dialogs are inert and hidden from accessibility while the top review is active.

Browser storage for reading return contains bounded IDs and relative anchors, not prose, private world truth, credentials or contribution drafts. Historical Codex/timeline/evidence queries restrict data to the inspected ancestry and moment. Hidden-only changes are filtered before pagination. Submitted text and correction reasons remain outside public evidence; narration quotes carry the exact immutable source hash, while legacy records retain passage-level attribution. Private planning uses an explicit authenticated route and clears its DOM on leaving. Owner drafts stay in authenticated SQLite storage, never browser prose storage; compare-and-swap prevents silent cross-tab overwrites. Lock cancels queued writes, clears UI and fences late callbacks. Acknowledged in-flight writes may finish. Unknown request status does not authorize a replacement purchase: cancellation fences block a delayed undispatched original. Ordinary and quality approval resets clear the corresponding local/session consent family and do not cancel already authorized work. Book/private-save exposure boundaries remain distinct in Gate.

08 Data inventory and retention

The database holds owner authentication, session digests, provider assignments, encrypted vault material, playable graphs and model-call accounting. Normalized images live under the configured media root. The environment file may hold a plaintext provider credential protected by filesystem permissions.

Story data includes private motives, hidden world truths, directions and correction reasons as well as visible prose. Branch snapshots preserve earlier states. Removing a placement does not erase its historically referenced image. Retiring a fact is not secure deletion of its old versions.

Call metadata records roles, purposes, models, status and known/unknown charges. Rejected candidates and reviewer explanations are not saved as playable history. Do not claim that the remote provider also discards them: its retention is an independent service policy.

A book contains selected-path reading material. A playable save contains all paths and private state, but no credentials, provider configuration, consent or pending request authority. A cold installation backup contains more, including auth and vault records, and must be protected accordingly.

Browser consent flags are convenience preferences; the session CSRF token is held in memory. Keys entered in Settings are not placed in browser persistence. Lock clears private runtime state. Operating-system swap, backups and external provider logs are outside that UI clearing guarantee.

09 Authentication, origin and network

Setup requires a random terminal code and a distinctive 15–128-character NFC-normalized password. Password hashing uses asynchronous scrypt with random salt. Only opaque session-token digests are stored. Cookies are HttpOnly and SameSite=Strict, and Secure when the trusted request is HTTPS.

Remembered sessions have a seven-day idle and thirty-day absolute lifetime; unremembered sessions use eight hours idle and twenty-four hours absolute. Lock revokes one session. Password change revokes the others. Setup/login have bounded progressive delays and temporary attempt limits, not permanent lockout.

Private API guards execute before body parsing. Mutations need CSRF and same origin. Host validation limits DNS rebinding; restrictive headers constrain script, framing, MIME sniffing and referrer exposure. Static documentation remains public so a locked-out owner can read recovery instructions.

The executable forces auth on, even under NODE_ENV=test. Loopback is the default bind. Direct non-loopback HTTP requires explicit insecure-LAN opt-in. Prefer HTTPS through a loopback proxy with explicit allowed hosts and trusted-proxy configuration when remote access is necessary.

These controls do not encrypt the database or downloaded files. They do not make a compromised machine trustworthy. Test both accepted and rejected network paths before treating a changed deployment as secure.

10 Credential lifecycle

Environment credentials are read-only sources for the built-in provider profile. UI credentials are either process-session memory or AES-256-GCM vault entries. A random data-encryption key is wrapped using a separately salted, purpose-labelled password-derived key.

Explicit login can unlock an existing vault. A remembered browser session after restart can access local story data while the vault remains locked; re-entering the password restores plaintext provider access. Password change rewraps the data key rather than re-encrypting every secret entry.

Lock, final session expiry and disposal clear plaintext access. Terminal reset removes saved credentials with the owner and sessions while preserving stories and media. It uses the same DATA_DIR/DB_PATH resolution as startup and refuses missing or older-family databases.

Provider keys never belong in story prompts, saved JSON, public responses, screenshots, logs or issue attachments. Redaction reduces accidental exposure but is not permission to log complete upstream errors or request headers.

Custom provider endpoints are trusted destinations selected by the owner. HTTPS or supported loopback HTTP is required; OpenAI-compatible is a protocol claim, not proof of equal capabilities, retention or safety. Review each provider's terms and behaviour independently before sending sensitive material.

11 Untrusted output and semantic limits

A model response is a proposal, not a database command. Strict field, type, identity, evidence and ancestry checks constrain structured effects before any mutation. Character ownership, secret/public state, challenge decisions and quality permissions remain application rules.

Exact quotations support provenance but do not prove truth. A model can quote its own invented sentence, misunderstand a relationship, or reveal a secret in ordinary prose. Structural validation and a second model's approval cannot establish perfect semantic correctness.

The storyteller and optional reviewers receive bounded context that can include hidden facts and motives. Those facts are withheld from ordinary reader-state APIs, but a model may still narrate them prematurely. Do not store real-world secrets on the assumption that a fictional spoiler boundary is cryptographic.

Story text, imported text and previous dialogue are data. They do not authorise extra model calls, weaken output validation, change provider credentials or supply system-level instructions. Reviewers return bounded findings, not canon writes; repair uses the original authoritative context.

Render text safely and validate all exported data. A prompt-injection sentence must not become executable HTML or a command. No paid live benchmark is implied by deterministic test coverage; model behaviour needs separate, authorised, versioned evaluation.

12 Uploads, saves and historical data

Uploads are authenticated and CSRF-protected before parsing. Raster inputs have 20 MB and 40-megapixel ceilings, signature/container checks, fail-closed decoding, orientation normalization and metadata/animation removal. Active SVG and polyglot/trailing content are refused. Stored names are server-generated.

Playable saves are bounded gzip-JSON, not legacy manuscript ZIP archives. Import caps compressed and expanded bytes, validates exact fields, identities, cycles, ancestry, evidence and image digests before writes. It creates a new story with fresh IDs; staged files are cleaned on rollback.

Private saves are unencrypted and carry spoilers and directions. Provider consent, credentials and resumable request IDs never travel. Never open a save by executing its contents, trusting an embedded filesystem path or relaxing a failed preflight.

Startup inspects a private copy before allowing SQLite to touch an existing database. Old families and orphan journals are refused; sources and sidecars are not adopted or rewritten. Source-change checks require stopped writers for reliable operator handling and do not claim immunity to malicious filesystem races.

Back up complete stopped installations. A live copy can combine inconsistent database and journal states. Scratch inspection protects source files but is not a supported live-backup mechanism.

13 Reporting and operator checks

Report a suspected vulnerability privately through the repository's security advisory form. Include version, deployment shape, affected boundary, minimal reproduction and observed impact. Do not include real provider keys, passwords, cookies, full private saves or exploitable details in a public issue.

For suspected credential disclosure, revoke or rotate the affected upstream key through its provider, preserve a redacted incident record and inspect the actual exposure. Logging out cannot revoke a provider key or recall data already sent. Coordinate any destructive cleanup explicitly and retain recoverable evidence.

Before exposing an installation, verify loopback/proxy assumptions, HTTPS, allowed Host rejection, private API denial before unlock, CSRF denial, vault lock/re-entry and file permissions. Use dedicated fixture data rather than a real private story for screenshots or public reproductions.

Before sharing a file, identify it correctly: book for readers, playable save for trusted continuation, cold backup for installation recovery. A book excludes private fields by construction but can still contain a secret leaked into prose by the storyteller. Read it before sharing.

Security review is required for new provider calls, storage/import formats, network trust, authentication, public routes, logging and new data projections. The absence of a failing unit test is not proof that an expanded trust boundary has been reviewed.

14 Optional reviewer exposure and authority

Quality can send bounded story context, hidden truths and motives, direction, candidate prose and proposed effects to the standard model, memory-support model, or both. They can be different provider profiles. The review names every selected role/provider/model and its call ceiling before purchase. A provider credential remains transport-only; it is never story context or reviewer content.

Quality is off by default. A per-configuration device consent cannot be inferred from the earlier one-call approval. The server checks the reviewed plan identity, all role availability and current story revision at every paid boundary. Browser consent is a user-experience record, not an authentication or CSRF substitute. Import never brings consent or pending request authority from another device.

Reviewers are untrusted advisers: direct quotations support bounded issues but do not prove semantic accuracy. Story text and earlier dialogue are data, not permission to override the review contract. The original context remains binding during repair. Application validations still govern ownership, structured challenge outcomes and effect evidence. Unstructured prose can still be wrong or disclose a secret. Do not advertise perfect resistance or treat repeated model agreement as independent verification. Only call metadata and aggregate spend persist; rejected drafts and reviewer reasons do not become reader-visible history.

15 Relationships, episodes and return recaps

The public recap is behind the existing authentication and origin boundary. It returns only the selected ancestry's narrated summaries, active public commitments and public relationships, never character motives or private correction reasons. The episode question is reader-visible working direction, not a secret-lore field. Opening a recap or episode dialog makes no model request.

Relationships use qualitative aspects, not numerical affection scores. An evidenced development cannot rewrite protected world truth or supply an inhabited person's feelings. Structured validation narrows permitted effects; arbitrary model prose can still be inconsistent. Example journeys and mocked tests are not a live-model certification. Optional standard/memory-model checks follow the bounded quality contract; they remain fallible and require their own purchase authority.

16 Characters addressing the user

Fourth-wall dialogue is an optional Living-world presentation permission, not an authentication, knowledge or authority exception. The same narration purchase covers an optional bounded address. Never rejects structured addresses; Rarely adds a durable scene-gap check; Freely removes that gap but not cast/ownership validation. The narrator may not supply an inhabited character's address.

Instructions prohibit hidden-truth disclosure, invented user speech, pressure to return or spend, and using an aside to override resistance. Asides cannot be evidence for effects or adjudication. Structural enforcement is not a semantic guarantee for the model's unrestricted prose. Addresses form part of readable prose and therefore appear in exported books; they are not private annotations.

17 Influence and recall boundary

The new memory, evidence and challenge-review routes use the same authentication, same-origin and CSRF middleware as the game. Memory search filters secret and retired facts before limiting results; evidence reads reject other paths. Private correction reasons and challenge requirements remain absent. An invitation is constructed only from reader-visible facts and never makes a provider request.

Challenge review grants no authority to change state. The submitted reply still requires its exact reviewed revision, and changed grounds cannot turn a free repeat into a paid action behind the player's back. No new telemetry or provider logging is introduced. Model prose remains fallible despite validated rulings.

18 Resistance is not a security boundary

A character's refusal is a game-design contract, not an access-control mechanism for the real application. Story text, pleas and claimed authority cannot write the application-owned challenge decision directly. Evidence must exist as recorded world state, but models can still misinterpret how narrative evidence arose. Outcome-field and quotation checks are useful structural safeguards, not a proof of semantic consistency. Do not describe the system as immune to persuasion.

Private challenge motives, requirements and basis hashes are omitted from reader responses. Selected challenge definitions and relevant historical facts may enter the reviewed narrator context; they also belong in the private playable save, not reader-facing books. No new credentials, background calls or telemetry are added. World corrections remain explicit owner actions outside the fictional contest.

19 Images and saves

Image upload and binary save import remain behind authentication, same-origin and CSRF checks before body parsing. Uploaded rasters are container-checked, pixel/byte bounded, stripped of metadata/animation and normalized. Image reads are story-scoped, authenticated and no-store. SVG, forged containers and broken digests fail closed.

Painting sends only the selected passage and art direction to the reviewed Illustrator; it does not send private facts, motives or uploaded references. Each press permits one attempt. A rejection after provider completion still records its known charge; uncertain dispatch is not reported free.

Catalogue/reference painting instead sends the selected name, visible description, appearance/setting and art direction; story covers use title and premise. Private world lore and character motives/background are excluded from image prompts. No upload is silently used as a provider reference. Catalogue routes inherit the same auth/CSRF boundary, and asset reads bind both image and owning entry.

AI reference development has a different, explicit exposure: it sends every field currently entered in that studio, including private lore, motives and background, to the reviewed Storyteller. The response is untrusted structured data, validated into the selected world/character/Scribe shape and returned as an editable unsaved draft. One invalid response permits only one corrective call. Idempotency prevents duplicate purchases; the schema-23 journal preserves known charges or uncertain attempts across failure and restart. A draft never silently creates or updates a catalogue entry.

Narration may receive bounded frozen world lore, character profiles and Scribe craft alongside other private story context. References are untrusted setup data, not instructions or established events. Reader responses omit private catalogue fields; books omit reference portraits as well. Saves deliberately contain frozen private references and their story-owned images. A reusable catalogue deletion does not erase those copies from existing stories, saves or operator backups.

A playable save is unencrypted and contains spoilers, private motives and directions across all paths. It excludes credentials, provider configuration, consent and live request authority. Books exclude those private game surfaces altogether. Import has hard compressed/expanded bounds, validates all references and media, and creates a new copy transactionally without interpreting paths or storage keys from the file.

20 Reader boundary

The new reader starts private requests only after unlock. Lock clears prose, cast, facts, input drafts and credential fields. Route epochs discard late UI responses; leaving a story does not pretend to cancel a provider request already dispatched. All story text is rendered with text nodes, not interpreted HTML. Secret facts and private correction reasons are excluded from normal story responses, but selected hidden truth is disclosed as part of the paid narrator's provider exposure.

The client submits the provider/model shown in review. A changed storyteller role rejects the request before purchase; replaying a completed key remains free even after configuration changes. Paid consent follows the existing remembered-device policy: a review is not necessarily shown on every later click. Off permits one billable attempt; enabled quality has its own reviewed four- or six-call ceiling. Failures retain known charges and unknown attempts. Estimates are not caps.